



Red Hat

Linux

BEFORE YOUR LINUX INTERVIEW, READ THIS FIRST

Linux Interview Questions – With Clear Answers

Linux Basics

1. What does `ls -ltr` do?

Lists files in long format, sorted by time, oldest first.

2. Difference between `cd` and `pwd`?

`cd` changes directory, `pwd` shows current directory path.

3. How do `cp`, `mv`, `rm`, `mkdir`, `rmdir` work?

`cp` copies files, `mv` moves/renames, `rm` deletes, `mkdir` creates directory, `rmdir` removes empty directory.

4. How to find files larger than 10MB?

```
find / -size +10M
```

5. How to find files modified in last 24 hours?

```
find / -mtime -1
```

6. How to read only a single line from a file?

```
sed -n '1p' file or head -1 file
```

7. Difference between `grep` and `egrep`?

`egrep` supports extended regex. (`egrep` $\approx$ `grep -E`)

Process & System Monitoring

8. Difference between `ps aux` and `ps -ef`?

Both show processes. Output format differs. `ps aux` is BSD style, `ps -ef` is UNIX style.

9. Process using most CPU?

```
top or ps aux --sort=--%cpu | head
```

10. Process using most memory?

```
ps aux --sort=--%mem | head
```

11. How do `top` / `htop` help?

Real-time CPU, memory, process monitoring.

12. How to check memory usage?

```
free -m
```

13. How to check disk usage?

```
df -h
```

14. How to check folder size?

`du -sh folder_name`

15. What does `uptime` show?

System running time and load average (1, 5, 15 mins).

16. Find which process is using a port?

`ss -tulnp` Or `netstat -tulnp`

17. What does `vmstat` provide?

CPU, memory, swap, I/O statistics.

18. How do you kill a process?

`kill PID` or `kill -9 PID`

19. How to troubleshoot CrashLoopBackOff?

Check pod logs, events, resource limits, and container startup errors.

Networking & OS

20. Check open/listening ports?

`ss -tulnp`

21. Check network connectivity?

`ping`, `telnet`, `nc`

22. NACL vs Security Groups?

NACL is stateless, SG is stateful.

23. Package not found during install?

Update repo, check repo config, verify package name.

24. Change file permissions?

`chmod 755 file`

25. Change file ownership?

`chown user:group file`

26. Hard link vs Soft link?

Hard link points to inode, soft link points to filename.

Shell / Automation

27. Script to alert if CPU > 80%?

Check CPU via `top` or `mpstat`, compare value, send mail/alert.

28. What is `xargs`?

Pass command output as arguments to another command.

29. Cron job every 5 minutes?

`* / 5 * * * * command`

□ Logs & Troubleshooting

30. Check logs for a running process?

`journalctl -u service-name`

31. Debug service or system down?

Check status → logs → disk/memory → restart service.

32. Check file existence, size, permissions?

`ls -l, stat file`